Credits

A game created by

Diego and Gemma

Thank you to everyone who supported us and helped make this game happen.

To those who tried the first versions, put up with games played with half-finished cards and kindly told us what was not working. To those who suggested animals, abilities and rules. And to those who simply sat down to play one more game.

This game is yours too.

Thanks for playing!

© 2026 Diego and Gemma. All rights reserved.
Developed with the help of artificial intelligence.



GAME RULES

2 to 7 players · Classic edition

Welcome to Animals

Deep in the forest there is room for everyone. Monkeys, parrots, dolphins and lions are looking for a quiet place to call home, and they all go crazy for the same thing: **acorns**.

Each player looks after their own sanctuary. You start with a handful of acorns and three very friendly, rather sleepy sloths. Turn by turn you will invite new animals by offering them acorns, and each one will help you with its ability so that more friends can come.

Goal

Gather the collection of cards worth the most **victory points (VP)** when the last round ends.

Contents

Cards	Copies
21 species costing 4 or less	9 of each
12 species costing 5 or more	7 of each
Sloths	21
Acorns of value 1	49
Acorns of value 2	16
Acorns of value 3	11
Acorns of value 5	8

378 cards in total.

Quick reference

Setup

- Each player: 7 acorns of value 1 and 3 Sloths. Shuffle and draw 5.
- Market piles: players + 2 copies if the cost is 4 or less, one copy per player if it is 5 or more.

Your turn

1. If there is a Squirrel in your discard pile, it returns to your hand.
2. Play animals and capture cards, in any order. Only one card of each kind per turn.
3. Captured cards go to your discard pile.
4. Discard everything and draw 5 cards.

Length

Learning	cost 4 or less	10 rounds
Intermediate	cost 6 or less	12 rounds
Full	all cards	15 rounds

Scoring

1. Add up the printed VP of your whole collection.
2. Add Eagle, Giant Panda, Orca, Albatross, Toucan and Shark.
3. Tie: most animals in the collection. If still tied, shared victory.

Other cards

Giraffe and Bat

The card you retrieve goes to your hand and you may play it this turn. **You may retrieve a card you have just obtained:** everything you get goes straight to your discard pile, whether with acorns, with the Spider or with the Elephant.

Rabbit

Reveal the top card of your deck. If it is an acorn or an animal costing 4 or less, it goes to your hand. If it is a more expensive animal, it stays on top of your deck. If your deck is empty, first shuffle your discard pile to form a new deck.

Tiger

Draw 2 cards, then put any one card from your hand on top of your deck. It does not have to be one of the cards you just drew.

Elephant and Spider

The animal you choose from the market is free and goes to your discard pile. Its ability is not applied.

Seal

You may combine its 3 acorns with others and split them among several cards. The only condition is that the Seal's acorns are used on aquatic animals.

Monkey, Platypus and Raven

The Monkey counts land **animals** and the Platypus counts **different species**. With 2 Sloths, a Monkey and a Platypus, the Monkey gives +4 acorns and the Platypus +3.

The Raven counts acorn **cards**, not their value.

Animal cards



1 **Cost.** The acorns you offer so it comes to your sanctuary. The Parrot costs **3**.

2 **Victory points.** What it is worth at the end of the game. The Parrot is worth **2 VP**.

3 **Name** of the species.

4 **Habitat.** An animal can have one or several.

5 **Ability.** It applies every time you play the card from your hand.

The three habitats

Land Flying Aquatic

The habitat is written under the name, and the card's scrolls are tinted to match.

An animal with several habitats counts for all of them. The Duck is both aquatic and flying, and its scrolls blend the two tints.

Example. You play the Parrot with a Duck in your hand. The Parrot counts itself and counts the Duck: you have 2 flying animals, so you get **+2 acorns** for this turn.

Acorns



Every animal loves acorns. Acorn cards have no name and no text: their **value** is the number carved on the acorn.

An acorn is **never played**. It stays in your hand and adds its value to the acorns you can offer this turn.

The acorn of value 1 cannot be taken from the market, so its cost is a dash. It gives no points either.

Acorn	Value	Cost	VP
Red panda	1	–	0
Sloth	2	3	1
Squirrel	3	5	2
Koala	5	7	3

Acorn cards and ability acorns

Many abilities say "+2 acorns". That does **not** give you a card: it only raises the acorns you can offer **this turn**. Any you do not use are lost.

Your **capture value** is the sum of the acorns in your hand and the acorns your abilities give you.

The Sloth

Cost 0 and 0 VP. It does nothing when played, but it protects you: when an opponent's card makes you discard, you may discard a Sloth instead of everything you were asked for.

Discard cards

The Hyena, the Snake and the Vulture make opponents discard. Each card goes to **its owner's** discard pile.

> **General rule.** If there is a tie or several possible cards, the choice always belongs to **the owner of the card** being discarded, never to whoever played the animal.

Hyena

Each opponent reveals their hand and discards their highest-cost animal. If several are tied for the highest cost, they choose which one. A player with no animals discards nothing.

Snake

Each opponent chooses an animal from their hand and discards it. Then you choose **one** of those animals and apply its ability as if you had played it. The card does not change owner. If you choose a **Flamingo**, the animal you exchange must be one of your own, never the other player's Flamingo.

Vulture

Each opponent chooses 2 cards from their hand and discards them. They can be animals or acorns.

Duck

The player you choose decides **which acorn to give you**. That acorn goes to your hand and is yours for the rest of the game. If they have no acorns, they reveal their hand and you add an acorn of value 3 from the market to your hand.

Sloth

Against the Hyena, the Snake or the Vulture you may discard **one Sloth** instead of what you are asked for. A single Sloth covers both cards of the Vulture. It does not work against the Duck.

Card clarifications

Flamingo

You return an animal to its market pile and take another of a **different species** costing at most 2 acorns more. The new animal goes to your discard pile.

- **You may use the animal before exchanging it.** Play that animal first, apply its ability, then play the Flamingo to exchange it.
- **It can be used on itself:** you return the Flamingo and take an animal costing 5 or less.
- The card you return stays in the market, and you may capture it with acorns that same turn.
- You may exchange a Sloth for an animal costing 2 or less. That Sloth **goes to the box**, not to the market: Sloths can never be captured.
- The exchange is free: it uses no capture value.

Turtle

Exchange an acorn in your hand for the next tier: 1 to 2, 2 to 3, or 3 to 5.

- **You exchange the acorn before using it.** The acorn you return goes to its market pile, or to the box if its value is 1.
- The acorn you get goes **to your hand** and you may use it this same turn.
- An acorn of value 5 cannot be upgraded.

Penguin

Take the acorn of value 2 from its pile. It goes **to your hand**, so you may use it this same turn. After that it is one more card in your collection.

Setup

1. **Starting deck.** Each player takes **7 acorns of value 1** and **3 Sloths**. Shuffle those 10 cards and place them face down: this is your deck.
2. **The market.** Place one face-up pile per species in the middle, with these copies:

Species	Copies in the pile
Cost 4 or less	players + 2
Cost 5 or more	one per player

With 4 players that is 6 and 4 copies. Leftover cards go back in the box.

3. **The acorns.** Make three piles with the acorns of value 2, 3 and 5. Leftover acorns of value 1 and Sloths go back in the box.
4. **Starting hand.** Every player draws **5 cards** from their deck.
5. **First player.** Whoever saw a wild animal most recently goes first. Play goes clockwise.

Your play area

- **Deck:** face down, on your left.
- **Discard pile:** face up, on your right. Everything you capture goes here.
- **Collection:** all your cards, whether in your deck, hand or discard pile.

> Choose the type of game before setting up the market. See page 8.

Your turn

On your turn you may play animals and capture cards, in any order and switching between the two. When you are done, end your turn.

Squirrel. First of all, if you have Squirrels in your discard pile, one returns to your hand. Only one per turn.

Playing animals

Place animals from your hand in front of you, **one at a time or several at once**, and apply their abilities one by one. Play as many as you like, or none.

When an ability mentions "your hand", it counts the cards in your hand **at that moment** and the ones you have already played this turn, including the card itself. If you play a Monkey and a Platypus, each one counts the other. Animals you draw later do not count.

If an ability cannot be fully carried out, do as much as you can.

Capturing

Add up your capture value and use it in the market:

- You may capture **several cards** in the same turn if you have enough for all of them.
- You may also take acorns of value 2, 3 and 5.
- Only **one card of each kind per turn**: not two animals of the same species, and not two acorns of the same value.
- Everything you capture goes to your **discard pile**, not to your hand.

The acorn cards you use are not lost: they are discarded at the end of the turn, like the rest of your hand.

> Animals from the Elephant, the Spider or the Flamingo do not count towards that limit, nor do acorns from the Penguin or the Turtle.

Scoring example

At the end of the game, this is Martha's collection:

Cards	Printed VP
1 Eagle	2
2 Parrots	2 + 2
1 Parakeet	1
1 Duck	1
1 Monkey	3
1 Giant Panda	0
1 Shark	0
3 Sloths	0
7 acorns of value 1	0
2 acorns of value 2	1 + 1
Printed points	**13**

- **Eagle:** Eagle, 2 Parrots, Duck and Parakeet, which counts double. That is 6 flying animals: **+6**.
- **Giant Panda:** Giant Panda, Monkey and 3 Sloths. That is 5 land animals: **+5**.
- **Shark:** 9 acorn cards: **+9**.

> Martha's total: 13 + 6 + 5 + 9 = **33 VP**.

For the tiebreaker, Martha has 11 animals in her collection.

Scoring cards

These six cards give extra points depending on the rest of your collection.

Card	+1 VP for each...
Eagle	flying animal
Giant Panda	land animal
Orca	aquatic animal
Albatross	different animal species
Toucan	animal costing 5 or more
Shark	acorn card, whatever its value

How to count

- Count your **whole collection**, not just your hand.
- The card **counts itself**. The Eagle is a flying animal and the Toucan costs 5.
- **Each copy scores separately.** With 2 Eagles and 6 flying animals you score 6 + 6 = 12 VP.
- An animal with several habitats counts for each of them. The Hippo is land and aquatic.
- The **Parakeet** counts as 2 flying animals and the **Goldfish** as 2 aquatic animals.
- **Cards from your starting deck count too.** Your acorns of value 1 count for the Shark. Your Sloths count as land animals for the Giant Panda and as one more species for the Albatross.
- Several copies of the same species count only once for the Albatross.

End of your turn

1. Put the animals you played and **all** the cards left in your hand, acorns included, in your discard pile.
2. Draw **5 new cards**. You will hold them during the other players' turns.
3. The player on your left takes the next turn.

When your deck runs out

If you have to draw and your deck is empty, shuffle your discard pile and place it face down as your new deck. Then keep drawing. This is how the animals you captured come back to your hand.

A round

A round ends when every player has taken one turn. Keep track of the rounds on paper or with a die.

> **Example turn.** Your hand is Parrot, Parakeet and three acorns of value 1.
>
> You play the Parrot. The Parakeet counts as 2 flying animals and the Parrot as 1, so you get +3 acorns. With your three acorns of value 1 your capture value is **6**.
>
> You capture a Penguin for 3 and a Dolphin for 3. Both go to your discard pile.
>
> You discard your whole hand and the Parrot you played, and draw 5 cards.

Types of game

Choose one before you start. The game always ends when the last round is over, so everyone plays the same number of turns.

Game	Market	Rounds
Learning	Only species costing 4 or less	10
Intermediate	Only species costing 6 or less	12
Full	All species	15
Custom	Whichever you like	Your choice

Learning game (optional)

Set up only the **21 species** costing 4 or less and the three acorn piles. The 12 expensive species stay in the box.

The cards are simpler and none of them scores in a special way, so final scoring is quick.

Intermediate game

The **30 species** costing 6 or less and 12 rounds. The Eagle, the Orca and the Giant Panda stay in the box.

Custom game

Feel free to play as many rounds as you like, with the animals you like. If you do not enjoy a card, simply leave it out of your games.

> **With young children** it is advisable to play without the variable-point cards: Eagle, Giant Panda, Orca, Albatross, Toucan and Shark. Leave them in the box: the game works the same, and scoring comes down to adding up the printed VP.

> If a market pile runs out, that card can no longer be taken. The game carries on as normal until the last round.

End of the game

When the last player finishes their turn in the last round, the game ends. Each player gathers **their whole collection**: deck, hand and discard pile.

Scoring

1. **Printed points.** Add up the **VP** on the shield of all your cards, animals and acorns.
2. **Collection points.** Add the points from the cards on the next page.

The player with the most points wins.

Tiebreaker

If there is a tie on points, the tied player with the **most animals** in their collection wins.

If they are also tied on animals, they **share the victory**.